

nebula Cloud of dust and gas in space that may eventually give birth to stars

observatory Any building or structure used to look into space. Optical observatories have a dome, often in a high-up location, housing a telescope. The roof can be opened to look at the sky. There are also radio observatories with big dishes, and space-based observatories (telescopes that orbit the Earth)

orbit Path an object makes around another object while under the influence of gravity

planet Large, round object orbiting a star

rocket Spacecrafts which carry satellites and people into space

satellite Object that orbits something larger than itself. The Moon is a natural satellite. Artificial satellites are objects put in orbit by humans

solar system Planets, moons, dwarf planets, comets, asteroids, and dust that orbit the Sun, held by its gravity

space Huge, largely empty areas in between the atmospheres of stars and planets. Space contains some dust and gas

spacecraft Vehicle or device designed to travel in space

space shuttle System used by the US government for 135 human space-flight missions from 1981 to 2011

space station Space laboratory orbiting the Earth, operated by crews of astronauts who live there for weeks or months

star Self-heating ball of glowing gas

Sun Star nearest to the Earth. It powers life on the Earth

telescope Instrument used to look at very distant things

UFO Unidentified flying objects are objects in the sky that people claim to have seen but cannot be identified. Some people cite them as evidence of life beyond the Earth

Universe Everything that exists – the Earth, Moon, Sun, all planets and all galaxies, and even those we haven't discovered yet

